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AS AMENDED

By: Strom, Deck, and Fugate of
the House

Hicks of the Senate

emergency 1

1. "Eligible Guard member" means a current member of the Oklahoma National Guard in good standing who has a high school

1 diploma or who has completed General Educational Development (GED)
2 requirements and who has enrolled in a technology center school;

3 2. "Program" means the Oklahoma National Guard CareerTech
4 Assistance Program established pursuant to the provisions of this
5 act; and

6 3. "Technology center school" means a technology center school
7 district under the governance of the State Board of Career and
8 Technology Education.

9 C. 1. There is hereby created the Oklahoma National Guard
10 CareerTech Assistance Program to provide assistance to eligible
11 Guard members who enroll in a technology center school. Subject to
12 the availability of funds, the amount of assistance shall be
13 equivalent to the amount of tuition for a career and technology
14 program in which the eligible Guard member is enrolled leading to
15 certification or licensure, not to exceed a maximum of three (3)
16 years.

17 2. Assistance provided pursuant to this section shall be
18 granted, without any limitation other than the amount of funds
19 available for the program and the number of eligible Guard members
20 who apply, subject to any cap established by the Military Department
21 of the State of Oklahoma.

22 3. Assistance provided pursuant to this section shall not be
23 allowed for courses taken in excess of the requirements for
24

1 completion of a technology center school program leading to
2 certification or licensure.

3 D. Assistance provided pursuant to this section shall be
4 allocated to the technology center school from the Oklahoma National
5 Guard CareerTech Assistance Revolving Fund created pursuant to
6 Section 2 of this act.

7 E. To be eligible to apply for the program, an eligible Guard
8 member shall:

9 1. Have at least one (1) year remaining on his or her
10 enlistment contract at the beginning of any semester for which the
11 member applies for assistance pursuant to this section;

12 2. Agree in writing to complete his or her current service
13 obligation in the Oklahoma National Guard; and

14 3. Agree in writing to serve actively in good standing with the
15 Oklahoma National Guard for not less than twenty-four (24) months
16 after completion of the last semester for which the member receives
17 assistance pursuant to this act.

18 F. To retain eligibility for the program, an eligible Guard
19 member shall:

20 1. Maintain good academic standing and satisfactory progress
21 according to standards of the technology center school in which the
22 member is enrolled;

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1 2. Maintain the requirements for retention and completion as
2 established by the technology center school in which the member is
3 enrolled;

4 3. Maintain a minimum grade point average of 2.0 on a 4.0
5 scale;

6 4. Maintain satisfactory participation in the Oklahoma National
7 Guard; and

8 5. Possess a Military Occupational Specialty (MOS) or Air Force
9 Specialty Code (AFSC) after his or her first semester.

10 G. An eligible Guard member seeking assistance pursuant to the
11 provisions of this act shall submit an application on a form
12 prescribed by the Military Department of the State of Oklahoma to
13 the Educational Service Office of the Military Department prior to
14 the semester for which assistance is sought. The eligible Guard
15 member's Commander or his or her designee shall confirm a member's
16 standing and eligibility to the technology center school in which
17 the student is enrolled. The Military Department may establish a
18 cap on the number of eligible Guard members allowed to participate
19 per semester per technology center school program.

20 H. The eligible Guard member's Commander may deny an
21 application submitted by an eligible Guard member for continued
22 program assistance if he or she fails to comply with the provisions
23 of paragraph 1, 2, 3, 4, or 5 of subsection F of this section.
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1 **I. An eligible Guard member seeking assistance pursuant to this**
2 **section who is eligible for federal education benefits for**
3 **vocational training shall exhaust all such federal benefits, when**
4 **available, first.**

5 **J.** An eligible Guard member who has received program assistance
6 pursuant to the provisions of this act and who fails to comply with
7 the provisions of paragraph 4 of subsection F of this section shall
8 be required to repay an amount to be calculated as follows:

9 1. Determine the total amount of assistance provided pursuant
10 to the provisions of this act;

11 2. Divide the amount determined in paragraph 1 of this
12 subsection by twenty-four (24); and

13 3. Multiply the amount determined in paragraph 2 of this
14 subsection by the number of months the member did not fulfill the
15 requirements of paragraph 4 of subsection F of this section.

16 Repayments shall be deposited into the Oklahoma National Guard
17 CareerTech Assistance Revolving Fund created pursuant to Section 2
18 of this act.

19 **K.** An eligible Guard member who has received program assistance
20 pursuant to the provisions of this act and who fails to comply with
21 the provisions of paragraph 4 of subsection F of this section due to
22 hardship circumstances may request a waiver from repayment. A
23 waiver request shall be submitted in writing to the Adjutant
24 General.

1 **L.** By July 1 annually, the State Board of Career and Technology
2 Education shall notify the Adjutant General of the amount of funding
3 available in the Oklahoma National Guard CareerTech Assistance
4 Revolving Fund created pursuant to Section 2 of this act.

5 **M.** The State Board of Career and Technology Education shall
6 promulgate rules to implement the provisions of this act including
7 deadlines for submission of applications required by subsection G of
8 this section. The Military Department of the State of Oklahoma
9 shall promulgate regulations pertaining to the application process
10 and the determination of eligibility for the program. The Board and
11 the Department shall coordinate the promulgation of rules and
12 regulations, respectively. The Adjutant General may promulgate
13 regulations to implement the provisions of this act.

14 SECTION 2. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
15 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 14-141 of Title 70, unless there
16 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

17 There is hereby created in the State Treasury a revolving fund
18 for the State Board of Career and Technology Education to be
19 designated the "Oklahoma National Guard CareerTech Assistance
20 Revolving Fund". The fund shall be a continuing fund, not subject
21 to fiscal year limitations, and shall consist of all monies received
22 by the State Board of Career and Technology Education from state
23 appropriations provided for the purpose of implementing the
24 provisions of Section 1 of this act. All monies accruing to the

1 credit of the fund are hereby appropriated and may be budgeted and
2 expended by the State Board of Career and Technology Education for
3 the purpose of providing assistance to eligible Guard members
4 pursuant to the provisions of Section 1 of this act. Expenditures
5 from the fund shall be made upon warrants issued by the State
6 Treasurer against claims filed as prescribed by law with the
7 Director of the Office of Management and Enterprise Services for
8 approval and payment.

9 SECTION 3. This act shall become effective July 1, 2025.

10 SECTION 4. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
11 of the public peace, health, or safety, an emergency is hereby
12 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
13 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

14 COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON APPROPRIATIONS
15 April 23, 2025 - DO PASS
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